

Media & News

48 words · Media & News

NOUNS

headline

the title of a newspaper article, printed in large letters

The headline read: "Prime Minister Resigns After Scandal."

report

a factual account of an event or investigation published or broadcast

The report revealed widespread corruption in the industry.

source

a person, book, or document that provides information

The journalist refused to reveal her source.

coverage

the way an event or topic is reported in the media

The media coverage of the trial was excessive.

tabloid

a newspaper that focuses on sensational stories and celebrity gossip

The tabloids ran the story on their front pages for a week.

troll

someone who posts provocative content online to upset others

They're a real problem. The anonymity brings out the worst in people.

editorial

a newspaper article expressing the editor's opinion on a current issue

The editorial called for immediate reform of the justice system.

whistleblower

a person who exposes wrongdoing within an organisation

The whistleblower leaked documents showing the company had lied about safety.

article

a piece of writing about a topic in a newspaper, magazine, or online

She read an interesting article about sleep science.

press

newspapers and journalists considered collectively

The press has been highly critical of the government's response.

broadcast

a programme transmitted by television or radio

The emergency broadcast warned people to stay indoors.

censorship

the suppression of information considered harmful or sensitive

Censorship of the press is a serious threat to democracy.

paywall

an online system that blocks access to content until the reader pays or subscribes

I couldn't finish the article because it disappeared behind a paywall halfway through.

propaganda

information used to promote a particular political viewpoint, often misleadingly

The documentary explored how propaganda was used during the war.

disinformation

deliberately false information spread to deceive the public

Foreign agents used disinformation campaigns to influence the election.

ADJECTIVES

viral

(of content) spread rapidly and widely online
The clip went viral within hours of being posted.

biased

unfairly favouring one side over another
The coverage was clearly biased towards the ruling party.

sensationalist

presenting information in a way designed to shock or excite
The reporting was sensationalist and lacked any real evidence.

impartial

treating all sides equally and without bias
A good journalist should remain impartial, regardless of personal views.

breaking

(of news) newly happening and being reported for the first time
We interrupt this programme to bring you breaking news.

credible

able to be believed or trusted as accurate
Only information from credible sources should be shared.

misleading

giving a false or inaccurate impression
The headline was deliberately misleading.

VERBS

fact-check

to verify the accuracy of claims before publishing
Every claim in the article was thoroughly fact-checked.

allege

to state that something is true, or that someone has done wrong, without yet providing proof
The report alleges that the company knew about the fault for years and said nothing.

spin

to present information in a way that favours a particular interpretation
The party tried to spin the results as a victory despite losing seats.

PHRASAL VERBS

keep up with

to stay informed about current events or developments
I try to keep up with the news but it's overwhelming.

blow out of proportion

to exaggerate the importance or seriousness of something
The whole thing was blown completely out of proportion by the media.

play down

to make something seem less important or serious than it is
The government tried to play down the severity of the crisis.

switch off

to stop paying attention
It's all doom and gloom. No wonder people switch off.

COLLOCATIONS

a news outlet

an organisation, such as a newspaper, channel or website, that reports news to the public

The story was picked up by several major news outlets within hours.

freedom of the press

the right of journalists to report without government interference

Freedom of the press is a cornerstone of any democracy.

fake news

false or misleading information presented as genuine reporting

Social media has made it harder to distinguish fake news from real news.

IDIOMS

spread like wildfire

to become known very quickly by many people

The rumour spread like wildfire across social media.

no smoke without fire

if something is being said, there is probably some truth to it

I'm not sure I believe all of it, but there's no smoke without fire.

doom and gloom

a feeling of hopelessness, especially in how news is reported

Definitely. It's all doom and gloom. No wonder people switch off.

a hatchet job

a piece of writing or reporting that is unfairly harsh, written to damage someone's reputation

The magazine ran a hatchet job on the actor, cherry-picking quotes to make him sound arrogant.

shed light on

to help someone understand something by explaining it or giving them new information

The new report sheds light on why the project was delayed.

take with a pinch of salt

to not fully believe something because it may be exaggerated

Anything you read in the tabloids should be taken with a pinch of salt.

bury your head in the sand

to ignore a problem or unpleasant reality by refusing to think about it

He's been burying his head in the sand lately, saying it's all too depressing to watch.

a mouthpiece

a person or publication that speaks on behalf of another, often uncritically

The newspaper is widely seen as a mouthpiece for the government.

bring something to light

to make hidden or secret information known to the public

It was two local reporters who first brought the scandal to light.

SET PHRASES

as far as I know

used to say what you believe to be true while admitting you might not have the full picture

As far as I know, they still haven't confirmed the story officially.

from what I've heard

used to introduce information you picked up casually rather than confirmed yourself

From what I've heard, the factory's closing down early next year.

off the record

said privately, on the understanding that it won't be published or attributed to you

He told me off the record that the deal had already fallen through.

go on record

to state something officially and allow yourself to be named as the source

She wouldn't go on record, so the paper had to call her 'a source close to the family.'

MODERN SLANG

clickbait

online content with a misleading headline designed to attract clicks

The article was pure clickbait. The headline had nothing to do with the story.

news junkie

someone who follows current events constantly, checking for updates throughout the day

He's a total news junkie who scrolls through three different apps first thing every morning.

scoop

an exclusive news story that one outlet publishes before any of its rivals

The local paper got the scoop on the closure a full week before anyone else picked it up.